of bottles did make their way to our dressing room and we finished them off before we left Lord's.

There were Indian supporters everywhere and the stretch from the WG Grace Gate to St John's Wood Tube station was packed with fans waving the tricolour and celebrating. The traffic had come to a standstill, with people playing music on the road and enjoying the moment. The police were extremely patient and realized it was a special occasion. A large crowd had waited for us to leave and were all waving at the team bus and taking pictures as we finally left Lord's with the trophy. It was a day few of us would forget.

The victory, which had seen youngsters like Yuvraj and Kaif come to the fore, suggested that the core of India's team for the 2003 World Cup was gradually coming together. It also proved that we had a side capable of doing well in overseas conditions. In Zaheer Khan, Ashish Nehra, Javagal Srinath, Anil Kumble and Harbhajan Singh we had a more than competent bowling line-up, and with Sehwag, Sourav, Rahul, Yuvraj, Kaif and myself, we were capable of out-batting any opposition. Now it was important to sustain the momentum and peak at the right time to have a crack at the world title that had eluded us for so long.

England in India 2001

1st Test. Mohali. 3–6 December 2001

England 238 (N Hussain 85, ME Trescothick 66; H Singh 5–51) and 235 (GP Thorpe 62, ME Trescothick 46; A Kumble 6–81)

India 469 (D Dasgupta 100, **SR Tendulkar 88**, R Dravid 86, SC Ganguly 47; RKJ Dawson 4–134, M Hoggard 3–98) and 5–0

India won by 10 wickets

2nd Test. Ahmedabad. 11–15 December 2001

England 407 (C White 121, ME Trescothick 99, MA Butcher 51; A Kumble 7–115, **SR Tendulkar 1–27**) and 257 (MA Butcher 92, N Hussain 50; H Singh 5–71, A Kumble 3–118)

India 291 (**SR Tendulkar 103**, VVS Laxman 75; AF Giles 5–67) and 198–3 (D Dasgupta 60, SS Das 58, **SR Tendulkar 26**; RKJ Dawson 2–72)

Match drawn

3rd Test. Bangalore. 19–23 December 2001